

In Brief

Posted:

12:13 PM PDT · July 1, 2025



Image Credits:Automattic



-
- [Sarah Perez](#)

Automattic puts Tumblr migration to WordPress on hold

Automattic CEO Matt Mullenweg confirmed that the company is no longer working on migrating its Tumblr blogging platform to WordPress, as previously announced. The exec shared the news on [The Verge's Decoder podcast](#), published on Monday, saying that the project is "on hold" for an indefinite period.

"What we decided is that we want to focus as much on the things that are going to be noticeable to users and that users are asking for," he told the site. "This was more like an infrastructure thing, kind of like any big re-architecture. I still want to do it. It's just cleaner. But right now, we're not working on it."

The announcement also raises questions about what this means for Tumblr's integration with the open social web, known as the fediverse. By migrating its infrastructure to WordPress, it would have become a federated app. Mullenweg admits that was one of the arguments for making the move, but hints that it's no longer a priority.

“...in the meantime, I think if there was a big push to implement fediverse, we would just do it on the Tumblr code base,” he said.

Mullenweg also reiterated that Tumblr is not profitable, and is sustained from the profits of other Automattic products. Still, he said he believed in Tumblr’s future and plans to give it the runway it needs to figure things out.

Topics

[Automattic](#), [In Brief](#), [Social](#), [tumblr](#), [WordPress](#)

July 15, 2025
Boston, MA

From seed to Series C and beyond — founders and VCs of all stages are heading to Boston. Be part of the conversation. Save up to \$425 now and tap into powerful takeaways, peer insights, and game-changing connections.

[Register Now](#)

Newsletters

[See More](#)

Subscribe for the industry’s biggest tech news

☐

TechCrunch Daily News

Every weekday and Sunday, you can get the best of TechCrunch’s coverage.

Add TechCrunch Daily News to your subscription choices

☐

TechCrunch AI

TechCrunch’s AI experts cover the latest news in the fast-moving field.

Add TechCrunch AI to your subscription choices

☐

TechCrunch Space

Every Monday, gets you up to speed on the latest advances in aerospace.

Add TechCrunch Space to your subscription choices

☐

Startups Weekly

Startups are the core of TechCrunch, so get our best coverage delivered weekly.

Add Startups Weekly to your subscription choices

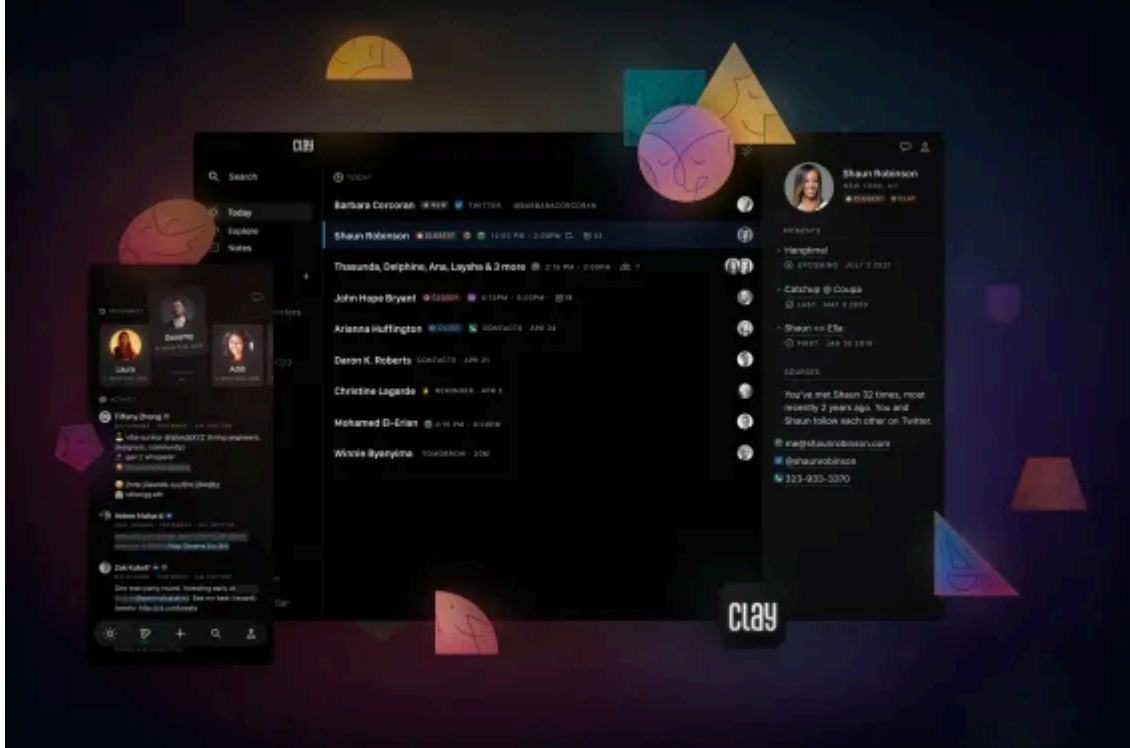
No newsletters selected.

Email address

Subscribe

By submitting your email, you agree to our [Terms](#) and [Privacy Notice](#).

Related

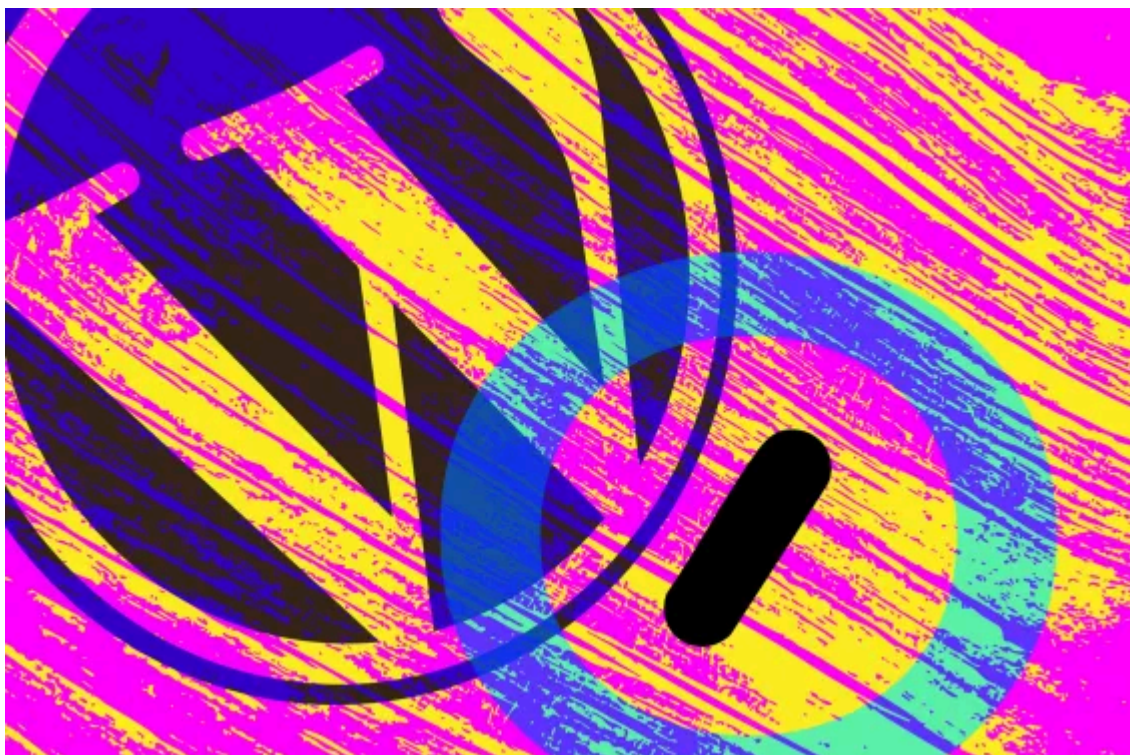


Startups

Automatic acquires relationship manager Clay to add an identity layer to online tools

- [Sarah Perez](#)

Jun 12, 2025



Enterprise

Automatic says it will start contributing to WordPress again after pause

- [Sarah Perez](#)

May 30, 2025



[Commerce](#)

[WordPress maker Automattic lays off 16% of staff](#)

◦ [Sarah Perez](#)

Apr 2, 2025

Latest in Social

[See More](#)



In Brief

[TikTok lays off more employees working on TikTok Shop US](#)

◦ [Amanda Silberling](#)

13 hours ago

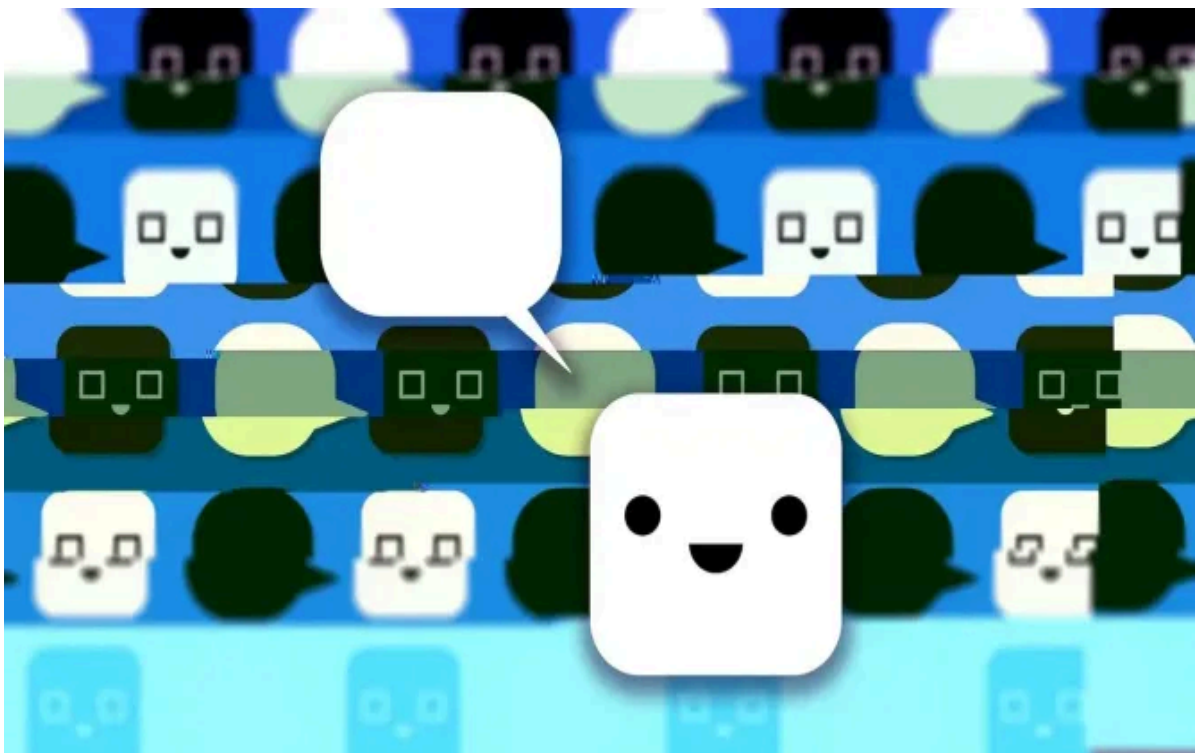


[Social](#)

[Meta users say paying for Verified support has been useless in the face of mass bans](#)

◦ [Sarah Perez](#)

15 hours ago



[Social](#)

[X is piloting a program that lets AI chatbots generate Community Notes](#)

◦ [Amanda Silberling](#)

1 day ago